Not Your Typical Dragon

By Dan Bar-el

NARRATOR: Crispin Blaze was born into a proud family of fire-breathing dragons.

FATHER: *(boasting)* Every Blaze breathes fire. I breathe fire. Your mother breathes fire. Tomorrow, when you turn seven, you'll breathe fire, too.

NARRATOR: The little dragon imagined all the forests he would burn down. He dreamed of all the castles he would destroy. He also considered boiling water to make tea, but he didn't tell his father that. The next day, Crispin sat among family and friends as a big cake was brought to the table.

MOTHER: Who will light the birthday candles?

CRISPIN: I will!

NARRATOR: He could feel a tingling inside his tummy. *(Crispin takes a big breath)* But when he opened his mouth, fire did not come out. *(Crispin starts to blow)*

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INTRODUCTION

When I was little, I was a "free spirit." I had this glorious silk scarf that I tied around my neck-- it billowed when I ran; red cowboy boots and swim goggles. I wore them constantly. With them, I was invincible and protected my family and my neighborhood from all forms of imaginary bad guys. Then one day my mother uttered those words . . . "What will the neighbors think." And she took my scarf, my boots and my goggles. My uniqueness was traded in for a conformity that would not draw undue attention.

I remember watching Rudolph putting mud on his nose so it wouldn't glow, and Hermy the Elf, who really wanted to be a Dentist, toil away making toys instead. They tried to fit in too. I thought, is fitting in really so important?

Maya Angelou once said, "If you are always trying to be normal, you will never know how amazing you can be." And Crispin finds that out in Not Your Typical Dragon by Dan Bar-el

CRISPIN: *(Blows with gusto and lots of mushy sound; he is shocked and embarrassed)*

NARRATOR: Whipped cream came out.

FATHER: *(shouting)* Crispin! Dragons breathe fire!

MOTHER: *(worried)* What will the neighbors think?

ASHLEY (C's Little Sister): I love whipped cream!

NARRATOR: The little dragon was whisked off to the doctor the very next day.

FATHER: *(demanding)* Please fix my son!

DOCTOR: What seems to be the problem? *(He turns to Chrispin . . . Crispin opens his mouth and breathes)*

NARRATOR: But fire did not come out. Band-Aids came out.

DOCTOR: *(he reacts, then speaks gravely)* I see.

FATHER: Dragons should breathe fire.

NURSE: We were low on Band-Aids.

NARRATOR: The doctor sent Crispin home with medicine. He swallowed two teaspoons before going to school.

FATHER: *(pouring out the last dose and giving it to Crispin)* It will help you become a real dragon. *(he winks)*

CRISPIN: *(swallows and makes a horrible face)*

NARRATOR: After school, Crispin joined his first fire breathing practice. One by one, little dragons aimed their fiery breath at stacks of logs until they burst into flames.

FIRST DRAGON: *(breathes fire -- Cheers)*

SECOND DRAGON: *(breathes fire -- Cheers)*

CRISPIN: *(steps up confidently)*

NARRATOR: He could feel the medicine bubbling in his belly. *(Crispin rubs his stomach)* But when he opened

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his mouth, fire did not come out. *(Crispin opens his mouth wide and reacts in shock and embarrassment)* Marshmallows came out. *(laughter)*

COACH: *(yelling)* Dragons breathe fire! Isn't that right, class?

NARRATOR: The other dragons didn't answer. They were too busy looking for pointy sticks for marshmallow roasting. *(dragon eagerly putting a marshmallow on a stick)*

CRISPIN: *(turning away dejectedly)* I guess I'm not a real dragon.

NARRATOR: He worried that his family would be disappointed. So, he ran away from home. *(Crispin sighs)* The world can be a scary place for a little dragon who can't breathe fire. Crispin found a dark cave.

CRISPIN: I'll be a fireless dragon all by myself. I won't bother anyone, and no one will bother me.

NARRATOR: [But] An hour later, he had a visitor.

SIR GEORGE: *(squeaky, scared voice from outside the cave)* I am Sir George. Sh-sh-show yourself, dragon! *(Crispin shuffles outside) (Sir George holds up a tiny sword)* D-d-do your worst, dragon!

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NARRATOR: *(Crispin opens his mouth)* But fire did not come out. *(Crispin hiccups repeatedly)* Soap bubbles came out. *(Crispin sighs)*

SIR GEORGE: *(popping the bubbles with the tip of his sword)* Don't you breathe fire, dragon?

CRISPIN: *(shaking his head)* I can't.

SIR GEORGE: *(moans)* But my father insists that I fight a fire-breathing dragon. *(sets down his sword and takes a book from his satchel)* It even says here in my book that your typical dragon breathes fire.

CRISPIN: I'm not your typical dragon.

SIR GEORGE: *(sighs)* I can't go home.

CRISPIN: Me neither. *(then he has an idea)* Maybe your book could tell us what to do.

SIR GEORGE: Of course! *(leafing through the pages)* It says it's probably just your diet.

NARRATOR: Sir George fed Crispin spicy curry, scorching chili, and blistering salsa. *(Crispin eats and sweats, eats and sweats, then opens his mouth)* But fire did not come out. Red party streamers came out. *(Crispin shrugs)*

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SIR GEORGE: At least they're the right color. *(he searches through the book again)* Aha! It says it's probably your attitude.

NARRATOR: Sir George showed Crispin how to look mean and angry enough to breathe fire. *(Sir George makes a face, Crispin tries (x2))*

NARRATOR: Crispin opened his mouth. *(Crispin opens his mouth)* But fire did not come out. Soft, cuddly teddy bears came out.

SIR GEORGE: Hmmmm, we may have taken a step backward.

CRISPIN: *(sighs)* It's no use. I'm just not your typical dragon.

NARRATOR: But Sir George was not ready to give up.

SIR GEORGE: *(looking at the book)* Aha! The book says you're too stressed.

NARRATOR: Sir George made Crispin close his eyes while he described a quiet, relaxing day at the ocean.

SIR GEORGE: *(softly)* Do you feel calm? *(with urgency)* Now imagine a hundred shiny knights attacking you!

NARRATOR: Crispin opened his mouth. *(Crispin opens his mouth)* But fire did not come out. Beach balls came out.

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SIR GEORGE: Well, that's just plain weird. *(Crispin shrugs)*

NARRATOR: Secretly, Sir George was glad that Crispin couldn't breathe fire. He liked the little dragon and didn't want to fight him. Crispin liked the shiny knight, too, but he missed his parents.

CRISPIN: *(sadly)* Sir George, it's getting dark. I want to go home.

SIR GEORGE: *(patting him on the back)* Don't worry, little dragon. I will take you.

NARRATOR: Crispin's parents were relieved when he arrived home safely. Sir George was about to say good-bye when . . .

SIR GEORGE'S FATHER: There you are, boy! Why on earth are you playing with a fire-breathing dragon?

SIR GEORGE: *(intimidated, he speaks softly)* He's my friend, Father, and besides, he doesn't breathe fire.

SIR GEORGE'S FATHER: *(laughing)* A dragon that doesn't breathe fire? That's the silliest thing I've ever heard!

CRISPIN'S FATHER: *(storming outside)* My son is not silly! He may not breathe fire, but I certainly do! *(Lets out a powerful spray of flames)*

SIR GEORGE'S FATHER: Do your worst, dragon!

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NARRATOR: But then the flames scorched the lawn.

CRISPIN'S MOTHER: That's enough, honey.

NARRATOR: The flames singed the fence.

CRISPIN'S MOTHER: *(scolding)* You've made your point, dear, no stop showing off.

NARRATOR: The flames ignited the roof.

CRISPIN'S FATHER: *(Still spewing flames)* I can't stop breathing fire!

CRISPIN'S MOTHER: *(Panicked)* You'll burn our house down! You'll burn down the whole neighborhood!

NARRATOR: Dragons came running from all directions. They knew how to start fires, but no one knew how to stop them. Crispin suddenly felt a tingling in his tummy. *(Crispin rubs his stomach)* He felt a bubbling in his belly. *(Crispin opens his mouth)* But fire did not come out. A gush of water shot out! (Crispin puts out the flames) Crispin aimed the water at his father's flames. He saved his home, and he even saved the shiny man, who wasn't looking so shiny anymore.

EVERYONE: Hurray for Crispin!

NARRATOR: On Crispin's next birthday, there was a big party. Family and friends came from all over the land.

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Sir George and his family came, too. Lots of dragons were dancing. Crispin stood with his mouth open wide. Fire still did not come out. Music came out instead.

(Crispin dances and hums a favorite dance tune)

OLD UNCLE: Your son, he's not your typical dragon, is he?

FATHER: *(proudly)* No, my son is something special!

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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